KARNATAKA VETERINARY, ANIMAL AND FISHERIES SCIENCES UNIVERSITY, BIDAR

VETERINARY COLLEGE, SHIVAMOGGA – 577 204

Department of Animal Nutrition

ONE DAY WORKSHOP ON

“Role of Veterinary Service Functionaries and Academia in Resolving Nutritional Management Related Livestock Production Issues”

Date : 27th June 2025

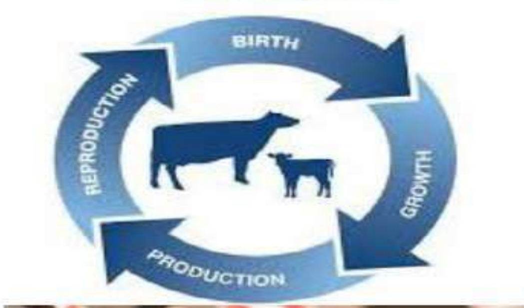
COMPENDIUM

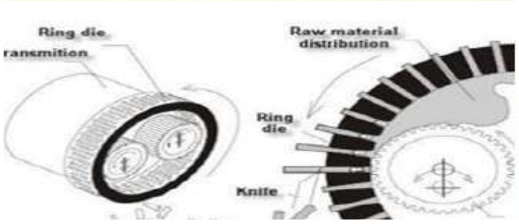
Invited Articles

Organised by

Dept of Animal Nutrition

Veterinary College, Shivamogga-577204





One Day Workshop on

"Role of Veterinary Service Functionaries and Academia in Resolving Nutritional Management Related Livestock Production Issues"

0n 27th June 2025

Compendium

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Practical Tips for Goat Nutrition Under Field Conditions

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Introduction

The goat is popularly known as "poor man's cow" and contributes to the livelihood security of rural India. Currently, India ranks first in goat population with about 148.8 million, supporting 3.30% of total milk production in India and goat meat (chevon) represents 14.47% of total meat production of the country. Goats—just like sheep—are accepted across all population in India as food animals without any cultural/social taboo. In order to realise optimum production and profitability, "balanced nutrition and feeding" become imperative in goat husbandry as feed alone is factored at over 0.65 of recurring expenses in goattery. India has some of the excellent breeds of goats adapted to local conditions like **Jamunapari, Beetal, Sirohi, Barbari, Jakhrana, Black Bengal, Osmanabadi, Malabari, Salem Black etc.** that are raised under either extensive (zero input), semi-intensive (minimum input) or intensive (stall-fed) systems. Goats are adaptable to climatic stress and relatively have low water requirements than other ruminants. In this article, the practical guidelines and tips to physiological/life stage-specific goat nutrition under stall-fed field conditions are briefly discussed.

Digestive physiology and special features of goats

Although both sheep and goats are small ruminants, goats prefer a variety of feedstuffs in their diet as they are more selective than sheep. Due to their mobile upper lip and prehensile tongue, goats can consume a wide range of tree foliages, bushes, twigs etc. including woody species and thorny botanical fractions that no other farm ruminants could relish. Besides, top feeds (foliages) help satisfy the "browsing" habit of goats through their characteristic bipedal stance. Indeed, goats could naturally utilise tanniferous foliages better than any other species of ruminants due to the presence of tanninolytic bacteria *Streptococcus caprinus* in the rumen. This apart, digestive physiology of goats is characterised by more taste sensation, salivary secretion, greater urea recycling through saliva leading to a relatively higher rumen ammonia concentration than sheep. Furthermore, a greater retention time of digesta enables goats to have a better digestive efficiency with coarse roughages. Notably, goats are naturally evolved to economise water usage by excreting less water through faeces and urine besides having a lower ratio of water-to-dry matter intake (DMI).